

RESQNET - EVACUATION SHELTER SETUP CHECKLIST

A practical setup guide for volunteer logistics teams. Complete each item before and during shelter operations.

1. CONFIRM THE SITE

- Receive site assignment and opening approval from the Incident Commander or shelter lead.
- Check that the location is outside immediate hazards and has safe, accessible routes in and out.
- Identify separate entry and exit paths, assembly points, and an accessible route for mobility aids.
- Confirm usable capacity, opening hours, emergency contacts, and backup communications.

2. PREPARE SHELTER AREAS

- Mark registration, waiting, sleeping, family, first-aid, information, and staff areas.
- Keep exits, corridors, fire equipment, and emergency vehicle access clear at all times.
- Set up lighting, drinking water, handwashing, toilets, waste bins, and cleaning supplies.
- Provide privacy, accessible spaces, clear signs, and a safe area for service animals.

3. OPEN AND OPERATE

- Record arrivals using the approved process; protect personal information and restrict access to records.
- Brief volunteers on roles, shift contacts, safeguarding, incident reporting, and evacuation procedures.
- Check supplies regularly and report shortages, damage, hazards, or capacity concerns to the shelter lead.
- Log incidents and hand over occupancy, supplies, open issues, and keys at each shift change.

IMPORTANT

Pause opening and contact the shelter lead if the site has an unresolved safety, access, sanitation, or capacity concern.